SERENE

AESTHETICS, WELLNESS AND IV INFUSION CENTER

FREE GUIDE

From Glow to Reset: Choosing a Facial, Peel or Laser

A step-by-step ladder for dullness, texture, pores, sun spots, fine lines and acne scars, matched to the downtime you can actually take

SERENE MED SPA · PHYSICIAN-LED

Hudson, Ohio · Barboursville, West Virginia

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Inside this guide

Educational guide · not medical advice

01 Start with your goal, then your downtime

02 Rung 1: No-downtime facials

03 Rung 2: Chemical peels, Laser Facials and CoolPeel

04 Rung 3: Light lasers and photofacials

05 Rung 4: Deeper resurfacing with CO2 lasers

06 Skin of color and melasma: go slower, not without

07 Prep, aftercare and sun protection

08 Combining treatments the smart way

09 Building your yearly skin plan

10 The resurfacing ladder at a glance

11 What it costs at Serene

12 Your consultation checklist

13 Frequently asked questions

Facials, peels and lasers can all help skin look smoother and brighter, but they are not interchangeable. A HydraFacial fits on a lunch break. A CO2 laser can need a week or more at home.

This guide lays out the options as a ladder. The bottom rungs are gentle, with no downtime. Each step up reaches deeper and asks more of you in recovery and sun care. The aim is to find the lowest rung that can realistically reach your goal.

Serene Med Spa is a physician-led med spa with offices in Hudson, Ohio and Barboursville, West Virginia. Not every treatment is offered at both offices, so each one below is labeled with where you can get it.

About Serene Med Spa

Serene is a physician-led med spa with offices in Hudson, Ohio and Barboursville, West Virginia, led by Robin Arora, MD and Shweta Arora, MD. We plan every treatment around your goals and health history, and we'll tell you plainly what a treatment can and can't do.

PART 01

Start with your goal, then your downtime

Two questions narrow the choices fast. What bothers you most in the mirror? And how many days can you look pink, flaky or swollen? Here is how common goals tend to line up. These are starting points, not a diagnosis.

- Dull, tired or dehydrated skin: start with a facial (HydraFacial or DiamondGlow) or a light peel.
- Rough texture and visible pores: peels, CoolPeel, Moxi or PICO fractional, with a series usually needed.
- Sun spots and freckling: peels, photofacials, Moxi or CoolPeel.
- Fine lines: light lasers for early lines; fractional or full CO2 for deeper, etched lines.
- Acne scars: PICO fractional, fractional CO2 or Morpheus8. Most scars need a series and patience.
- Melasma (brown-gray patches, often on cheeks and upper lip): go slow and gentle. See the melasma section before booking anything with heat.

> **A useful rule of thumb**
> More downtime usually means more change per session. Less downtime usually means more sessions. Neither path is wrong.

PART 02

Rung 1: No-downtime facials

Medical-grade facials clean, exfoliate and hydrate the top layer of skin, and most people go right back to their day. They are a smart first step and a good way to maintain results between bigger treatments.

HydraFacial (Hudson and Barboursville) cleanses, exfoliates and gently suctions out oil and debris, then infuses hydrating serums, with optional boosters for brightening or clarity. It takes about 30 to 45 minutes and suits nearly every skin type.

DiamondGlow (Hudson only) uses a diamond-tip wand to resurface and extract while it pushes in a serum chosen for your skin. It is popular for dullness, dryness, congested pores and a pre-event glow. Classic facials and dermaplaning are offered at both offices.

- Downtime: none. Mild redness or tightness can last a few hours.
- How often: many people come monthly; no fixed series is required.
- Limits: facials refresh the surface. They do not reach deep lines, scars or deep pigment.

PART 03

Rung 2: Chemical peels, Laser Facials and CoolPeel

Chemical peels (Hudson and Barboursville) use a medical-grade solution to loosen damaged surface cells so fresher skin comes through. Serene offers the VI Peel and The Perfect Derma Peel, with the peel and strength chosen for your skin. Peels can help dullness, uneven tone, sun spots, rough texture, early fine lines and breakouts. Expect a few days of flaking and tightness; most people look normal within about a week. Peels are usually done as a series a few weeks apart.

The Laser Facial (Hudson and Barboursville) uses gentle laser energy to brighten tone and refine texture, with little to no downtime. A series builds results.

CoolPeel (Hudson only) is a gentle CO2 laser treatment on the DEKA Tetra platform, a step between a peel and full resurfacing. Ultra-short pulses remove a thin layer of damaged skin with very little leftover heat. It is used for pores, texture, dullness, fine lines, sun damage and light acne scarring. Most people are pink for about a day and flake lightly for 3 to 5 days. A typical plan is 3 treatments about a month apart, then 1 or 2 maintenance visits a year.

> **Good to know**
> Our Hudson team generally recommends CoolPeel for lighter skin tones (Fitzpatrick types I to III) and often suggests options such as Morpheus8 for deeper tones.

PART 04

Rung 3: Light lasers and photofacials

These treatments reach deeper than a peel while keeping recovery short. Plan on a series.

Sciton Moxi (Barboursville only) is a gentle, fractional, non-ablative laser: it treats tiny columns of skin without removing the surface. It is often chosen for early aging, uneven tone, freckling and texture. Skin looks mildly sunburned the same day, and flaking usually finishes in 2 to 5 days. A typical plan is 3 treatments about a month apart, then 1 or 2 a year. Moxi targets water rather than pigment, and the manufacturer says it can be used on all skin types with careful settings.

PICO fractional resurfacing (Barboursville only) uses a picosecond laser, which delivers energy in extremely short bursts with less heat. It is used for acne scars, pores, sun spots, uneven tone and fine lines. Most people have a few hours of redness and mild swelling. Plans are usually 3 to 4 sessions about a month apart. Clear Lift, a related no-downtime laser at the same office, can give a quick brightening boost.

Photofacials use broad-spectrum light to target brown spots and redness. Lumecca IPL is offered at both offices and Sciton BBL in Barboursville. Because they target pigment, they generally suit lighter skin tones.

PART 05

Rung 4: Deeper resurfacing with CO2 lasers

CO2 lasers are ablative: they remove skin in a controlled way so the body rebuilds it. This top rung can do the most for etched lines around the mouth and eyes, acne scars, heavy sun damage and crepey texture. It also asks the most of you.

Hudson uses the DEKA CO2 laser. Barboursville uses the Alma Hybrid CO2, which pairs fractional CO2 with a gentler non-ablative laser. Both offices offer two levels.

- Fractional resurfacing treats a grid of tiny columns and leaves healthy skin between them, which speeds healing. Expect redness, swelling and peeling, often for about 5 to 7 days. Lighter Hybrid settings may need less.
- Full resurfacing (maximum strength) treats more of the surface. Plan on about 7 to 14 days of healing, with pinkness that can fade over several weeks.
- Many people need one full-strength treatment. Fractional plans may be one session or a short series.
- Your consultation covers cold sore history, medications and skin type. An antiviral medicine is often given to help prevent a cold sore flare.

> **Where Morpheus8 fits**
>
> Morpheus8 (both offices) is not a laser. It combines microneedling with radiofrequency heat below the surface for texture, acne scars and mild laxity. Our team often suggests it for deeper skin tones when surface lasers carry more pigment risk.

PART 06

Skin of color and melasma: go slower, not without

People of every skin tone can benefit from resurfacing, but skin with more natural pigment reacts more strongly to heat and injury. The most common problem is post-inflammatory hyperpigmentation (PIH): dark patches that appear after irritation. PIH usually fades, but it can take months.

Devices that target pigment (IPL and BBL) and strong heat (full CO2) generally carry more risk for deeper skin tones. Gentler options such as Moxi, PICO fractional, lighter peels and Morpheus8 are often used instead, or lower settings. Our team most often recommends CoolPeel and DEKA CO2 for lighter skin tones, while the Alma Hybrid in Barboursville can be adjusted for a wider range of skin types.

- Ask about a test spot if you tan easily or get dark marks after acne or injury.
- Your provider may recommend a few weeks of skin prep, which can include a pigment-lightening cream, before a peel or laser.

- Melasma tends to come back and is triggered by sun, heat and hormones. Aggressive heat can sometimes make it darker, so gentle, gradual plans and strict sun protection are the usual approach.
- Avoid tanning, sunburn and self-tanner for several weeks before any peel or laser.

PART 07

Prep, aftercare and sun protection

Your provider will give instructions for your exact treatment. These are the common themes.

- Before: share all medications, supplements and skin products, any cold sore history, and any prescription oral acne medication in the past year.
- Before: pause retinoid products and strong exfoliants if your provider asks. Tell us if you are pregnant or breastfeeding, have an active rash or infection, or tend to scar.
- After a facial: skip heavy workouts, saunas, hot tubs and pools for 24 to 48 hours, and avoid retinoids and scrubs for a few days.
- After a peel: keep skin clean and moisturized, do not pick flaking skin, avoid retinoid products and acids for 3 to 5 days, and avoid sun and heat for 3 to 7 days.
- After a laser: follow your gentle cleanser and ointment or moisturizer routine and keep follow-up visits.
- Contact us for severe pain, spreading redness, blisters, yellow crusting, fever or anything that worries you.

> **Sunscreen is part of the treatment**
> New skin burns and darkens easily. Use a broad-spectrum SPF 30 or higher every day, reapply outdoors, and add a wide-brimmed hat and shade. Tinted mineral sunscreens with iron oxide are a good choice if you are prone to pigment. Many people schedule lasers and stronger peels in fall and winter, when sun exposure is lower.

PART 08

Combining treatments the smart way

Most real-life plans mix rungs. The key is spacing, so skin fully heals before the next step.

- Facials pair well with almost everything. Many people book one between laser or peel sessions, once skin has healed.
- Some treatments can share a visit. In Barboursville, Moxi and BBL are sometimes done the same day to target texture and spots together.
- Space most peels and lasers about 4 weeks apart unless your provider advises otherwise.
- Wrinkle relaxers (neuromodulators) and fillers are usually scheduled on a different day than peels and lasers. Ask about the right order and gap.

- Morpheus8 and CO2 can both fit a long-term plan, usually in separate sessions.
- Daily home care, especially sunscreen, helps in-office results last.

PART 09

Building your yearly skin plan

A yearly plan helps you budget, time big events and avoid chasing one-off treatments. Here are sample plans; yours will be tailored to your skin.

- Glow maintainer: HydraFacial or DiamondGlow every 1 to 2 months, plus a light peel in fall.
- Texture and pores: 3 CoolPeel (Hudson) or Moxi (Barboursville) treatments in fall or winter, then facials and 1 or 2 maintenance sessions a year.
- Sun spots: a photofacial series in the cooler months, a peel or Moxi for tone, and sunscreen year-round.
- Acne scars: once breakouts are controlled, a series of PICO fractional, fractional CO2 or Morpheus8 sessions.
- Bigger reset: one CO2 treatment in late fall or winter, then gentle maintenance once or twice a year.
- Event timing: a facial 3 to 7 days before, a peel or light laser at least 2 weeks before, and CO2 at least 4 to 6 weeks before.

> **Results vary**
> Skin type, age, sun habits, smoking and home care all affect how your skin responds. Results build gradually and need maintenance as skin keeps aging.

The resurfacing ladder at a glance

Treatment	Often chosen for	Typical downtime	Typical series	Where at Serene
HydraFacial	Dullness, congestion, dehydration	None	Optional; often monthly	Hudson and Barboursville
DiamondGlow	Dullness, texture, pores, dryness	None	Optional; often monthly	Hudson
Chemical peels (VI Peel, Perfect Derma Peel)	Uneven tone, sun spots, texture, breakouts	A few days to a week of flaking	Series a few weeks apart	Hudson and Barboursville
Laser Facial	Dullness, uneven tone, early aging	Little to none	Series, then maintenance	Hudson and Barboursville
CoolPeel (CO2)	Pores, texture, sun damage, fine lines	About 1 day pink; 3 to 5 days flaking	3, about a month apart	Hudson
Sciton Moxi	Early aging, tone, texture, freckling	1 to 2 days; flaking 2 to 5 days	3, about a month apart	Barboursville
PICO fractional	Acne scars, pores, texture, tone	A few hours of redness	3 to 4, about a month apart	Barboursville
Photofacial (Lumecca IPL; Sciton BBL)	Sun spots, redness	Spots may darken and flake for several days	Often a series of 3	IPL: both offices; BBL: Barboursville
Fractional CO2 (DEKA; Alma Hybrid)	Etched lines, acne scars, sun damage	About 5 to 7 days (lighter Hybrid settings shorter)	1 to 3, per plan	DEKA: Hudson; Alma Hybrid: Barboursville
Full CO2 resurfacing	Deeper wrinkles, heavy sun damage, scarring	About 7 to 14 days; pinkness for weeks	Often 1	DEKA: Hudson; Alma Hybrid: Barboursville
Morpheus8 (not a laser)	Texture, acne scars, mild laxity; all skin tones	Ask at consult	Often a series of 3	Hudson and Barboursville

What it costs at Serene

Treatment	Hudson, OH	Barboursville, WV
HydraFacial Per treatment	$149	$150
DiamondGlow	$150	Not offered
Facials and dermaplaning	$100+	$100+
VI chemical peels Price depends on peel and strength	$250+	$250+
Acne peel Acne back peel $150	$100	$100
Laser Facial	$400	$400
CoolPeel Series of 3 recommended	$400	Not offered
Sciton Moxi Series of 3 recommended	Not offered	$500
PICO fractional resurfacing Depends on area and settings	Not offered	Quoted at consultation
Lumecca IPL, full face Series of 3: $1,050; add neck or chest $150	$400	$400
Sciton BBL	Not offered	$400
Fractional CO2 resurfacing Per session	$600 (DEKA)	$600 (Alma Hybrid)
Full CO2 resurfacing (maximum strength) Per session	$1,000 (DEKA)	$1,000 (Alma Hybrid)
Morpheus8 Series of 3: $2,100	$800	$800

Prices as of October 2026; see serenemedspas.com for current pricing. Prices are starting points and your final cost is confirmed at your consultation. Ask about current seasonal specials.

Your consultation checklist

- [ ] What is my main goal, and which rung of the ladder can realistically reach it?
- [ ] How many days of downtime should I plan for, and what will my skin look like each day?
- [ ] How many sessions will I likely need, and what is the total cost of the series?
- [ ] What is my Fitzpatrick skin type, and how does it change which devices and settings are safe for me?
- [ ] Should I do a test spot or a few weeks of skin prep first?
- [ ] Which products and medications should I pause before treatment, and for how long?
- [ ] Is this treatment offered at the office closest to me?
- [ ] How do you handle side effects like dark spots, blisters or a cold sore flare?
- [ ] Who will perform my treatment, and how is a physician involved in my plan?

Frequently asked questions

What is the difference between ablative and non-ablative lasers?
Ablative lasers, like CO2, remove a thin layer of skin so new skin forms. They can do more per session but need more healing time. Non-ablative lasers, like Moxi, heat the skin below the surface without removing it, so recovery is shorter and more sessions are usually needed.

Does resurfacing hurt?
Facials are comfortable. Peels can sting or feel warm briefly. For lasers, numbing cream is applied first, and most people describe a warm, prickly feeling.

I have darker skin. Can I still get laser treatment?
Often, yes, with the right device and settings. A provider experienced with your skin type should choose the plan, and a test spot may be suggested.

Can lasers fix melasma?
Melasma tends to come back, and no treatment can promise to clear it. Gentle, gradual plans with daily sun protection are the usual approach. Strong heat can sometimes make melasma darker, so tell your provider if you have it.

Why is a treatment only offered at one office?
Each office has its own set of devices. Hudson offers DiamondGlow, CoolPeel and the DEKA CO2 laser. Barboursville offers Moxi, PICO fractional, BBL and the Alma Hybrid CO2. HydraFacial, chemical peels, the Laser Facial, IPL and Morpheus8 are offered at both.

How long do results last?

It depends on the treatment, your skin and your sun habits. Facials give a short-term glow. Peel and laser results can last longer, but skin keeps aging, so many people plan 1 or 2 maintenance treatments a year.

YOUR NEXT STEP

Ready when you are

- Book a consultation online: Hudson at https://serenemedspas.com/hudson/ or Barboursville at https://serenemedspas.com/barboursville/.
- Prefer to text? Hudson: (330) 303-2031. Barboursville: (304) 396-0295. Tell us your goal and downtime, and we will point you to the right office and treatment.
- New clients: "20% off your first visit — applies to any product or service; can't be combined with another discount".
- From October 21, 2026, both offices offer a free InBody 580 body-composition scan. It takes about a minute.



Hudson, Ohio

50 W Streetsboro St, Suite 2
Text (330) 303-2031 · Call (330) 460-5915
serenemedspas.com/hudson



Barboursville, West Virginia

1 Chateau Grove Ln
Text (304) 396-0295 · Call (304) 520-0461
serenemedspas.com/barboursville

Scan a code to see pricing and book online.

Important

This guide is for general education only and is not medical advice, and it does not replace a consultation with a licensed medical provider. Facials, peels and lasers carry risks, including irritation, infection, pigment changes and scarring. Results vary; no specific outcome is promised. Downtime and series lengths are general ranges. Prices are as of October 2026 and may change; see serenemedspas.com for current pricing. In a medical emergency, call 911.

Sources

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